

KAVERI INGALE: POWERING POSSIBILITIES - LESSONS FROM A GLOBAL JOURNEY



KAVERI INGALE, Managing Director Ops, India & South Asia, Believe

Congratulations on being selected as one of the MPW – 2025, what does it mean for you?

Thank you. Recognition is always good. Being selected as one of the MPW 2025 goes beyond a personal achievement — it's a meaningful validation of my work and that of the teams I've been part of. It also serves as a reminder of the responsibility that comes with such recognition — to continue showing up with authenticity, to uplift others, and to keep creating real value. So, while it's an honour, it also strengthens my resolve to continue growing and to give back in meaningful ways. Moreover, being acknowledged alongside such distinguished leaders makes this recognition special.

Share your career journey, how have your perspectives changed or grown as a leader over the years?

My career started in tech and telecom. My consulting years at Nokia gave me invaluable international exposure to different work environments. An Australian stint taught me the value of strategic planning, in Germany I observed the importance of precision and sweating the details. APAC culture taught me the

power of process and protocol. And back home in India, I learned that sometimes progress matters more than perfection, especially in fast-moving environments. These, of course, are my personal observations, but each has shaped the way I approach leadership and execution today.

Later, being part of the Vodafone Idea merger, deepened my understanding of the human side of mergers. Integrations are about products, process but at the core also about people. Today, at Believe we encourage new business models and agility thus requiring quick decisive actions. This demands clarity of objectives and then a continuous communication of it, from its leaders.

Elaborate your role at Believe and how is it evolving?

Valued at around USD \$2 billion, Believe, established in 2005 as a digital distribution pioneer and now operates across 50+ countries, serving everyone from DIY creators to established independent labels and artists.

India and South Asia are not only critical growth markets but also very dynamic. A decade ago, independent artists held barely 15–20% of the Indian digital music market. Today, in some genres, they command even over 50%. This shift isn't by accident. It happened because tech opened the door, and companies like ours worked to build the systems, services, and support structures that helped creators walk through it.

At Believe, over the years we have focussed on building a strong foundation, then the scale through both organic and inorganic routes. Now we shift our focus to transforming for sustained success. This transformation demands a robust backbone — financial, legal, tech, people, and processes. As Managing Director Operations, my role is to lead these functions, mobilize the right programs to ensure seamless and agile execution across interdependent teams.

What is the best leadership advice you have ever received?

Leadership is not a title—it's a privilege. That privilege brings a deep sense of accountability. Real leadership is about creating an environment where talented people can do their best work. It's about clarity, consistency, and showing up for people even when no one is watching. That mindset has shaped the way I lead with intention, responsibility, and an understanding of the leader's role to empower others.

Any message or advice for our readers?

Teams with a strong sense of purpose are *over three times more likely* to be high performing. It's a powerful reminder that winning isn't driven only by talent or resources — it's fueled by meaning. When people truly believe in the 'why,' they unlock the creativity, resilience and collective strength needed to achieve the 'how.' That, to me, is the real power of leadership and teamwork. So, my message is simple: build purpose, back your people, and watch your teams go 3X.